

THE STORY OF WHY I BUILT IT

Lattice

I got tired of slide software that works against the person using it. So I built one that doesn't.

WHERE THIS STARTS

PowerPoint was a breakthrough nobody has questioned since.

Every tool since has copied its shape. A blank canvas. A master slide the whole deck inherits — until your first override sends the rest drifting. You still can't see what changed from one version to the next.

THE IDEA

So I made the deck a plain text file.

You write the words in Markdown, the plainest text there is. The engine holds the structure and the finish. Change a line and that is all that moves — poor taste runs out of places to hide.

THE NAME IS THE PLAN

Four words, borrowed from people who work with their hands.

Function

What is this slide for? You decide that.

Form

How is it built? From a fixed set of layouts, never a blank page.

Substance

What goes inside? The engine fills the slots.

Finish

How should it feel? One line changes the whole look.

— A tailor talks about form. A shoemaker talks about finish. I borrowed their words on purpose.

ONE RULE THE WHOLE THING RESTS ON

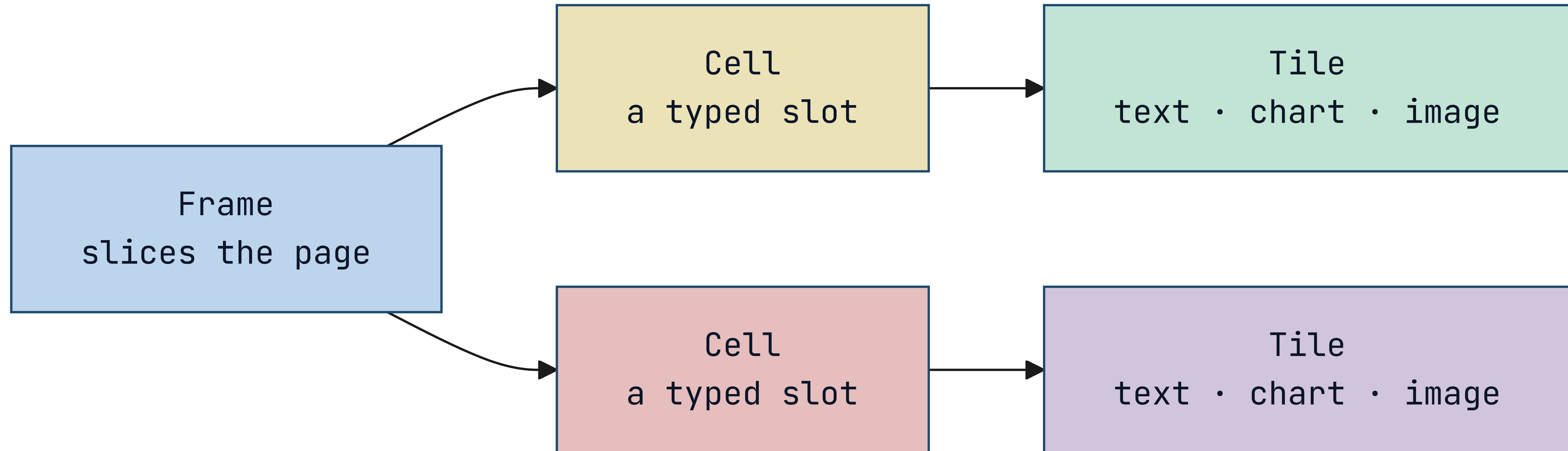
No layout ever names a colour.

Every colour comes from a token. Pick a palette and the colours change; the spacing, the type, and the structure do not move an inch. Reskinning an entire deck is one line.

FOR THE ENGINEERS IN THE ROOM

Every slide is three pieces.

A cell holds a tile, never another frame — I cut infinite nesting; it earns nothing on a slide.



TASTE, ENFORCED

The engine says no, so the deck stays clean.

Forty words a slide

Go past it and the engine tells you to split. The font never shrinks to make room.

Six bullets, then stop

A slide is not a document. The limit keeps it readable from the back row.

One idea per slide

When two thoughts are fighting, they each get their own page.

HOW IT GOT BUILT

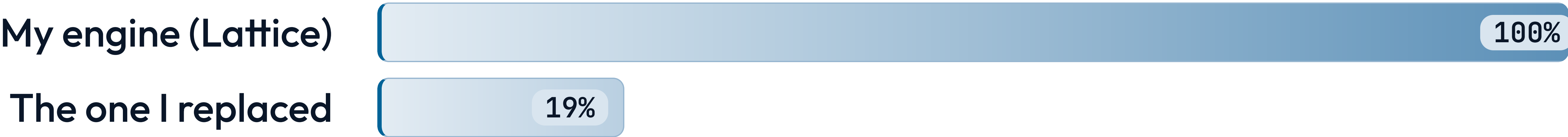
It started as a stylesheet and grew a spine.



- | | | | |
|---|---|---|--|
| A handful of layouts | A real catalog | My own engine | Learning to bend |
| April 2026. A small palette and a few cards, riding on a borrowed renderer. | Spring. Native charts, a typography system, a proper component library. | June. I replaced the borrowed renderer with one I own outright. | Now. The same deck reflows from boardroom screen to phone. |

WHAT CHANGED WHEN I DROPPED THE BORROWED RENDERER

My own engine draws a deck about five times faster.



— A seventy-nine-slide deck went from 208 milliseconds to 39, and the install shed 42 megabytes. I kept no fallback renderer. The new one stands on its own.

KEEPING IT HONEST

I had every layout graded twice, and the first scores stung.

One pass built each layout. A separate pass, blind to the first, tried to tear it down. The first score was a seven out of ten — solid bones, rough finish. So I set the bar at ten and held it there.

WHERE IT STANDS

What's in the box today.

50+

LAYOUTS, READY TO
DROP IN

14

COLOUR PALETTES, LIGHT
AND DARK

2,000+

TESTS THAT RUN ON
EVERY CHANGE

AA

CONTRAST THAT PASSES ON
EVERY SURFACE

WHAT'S NEXT

It is version one, and it is learning to bend.

Lattice runs on its own engine now. The work in front of me is reflow: one deck that reads right on a projector, a tablet, or a phone, without rewriting a word.

LATTICE · LATTICE.STYLE

THAT IS THE WHOLE IDEA

You write the words.
The structure holds.